

Lab: Obfuscation

Objective: Obfuscating source code

Tools required: XAMPP

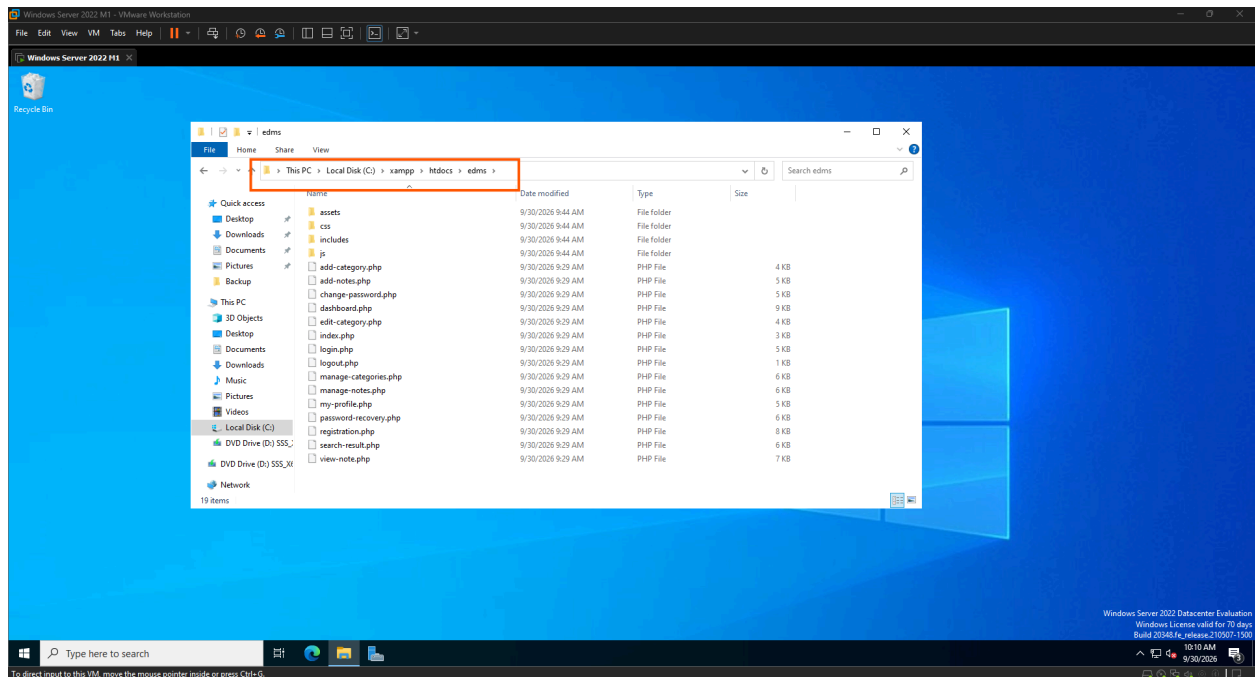
Prerequisites: Hosting of a webapp on XAMPP must be completed

Steps to be followed:

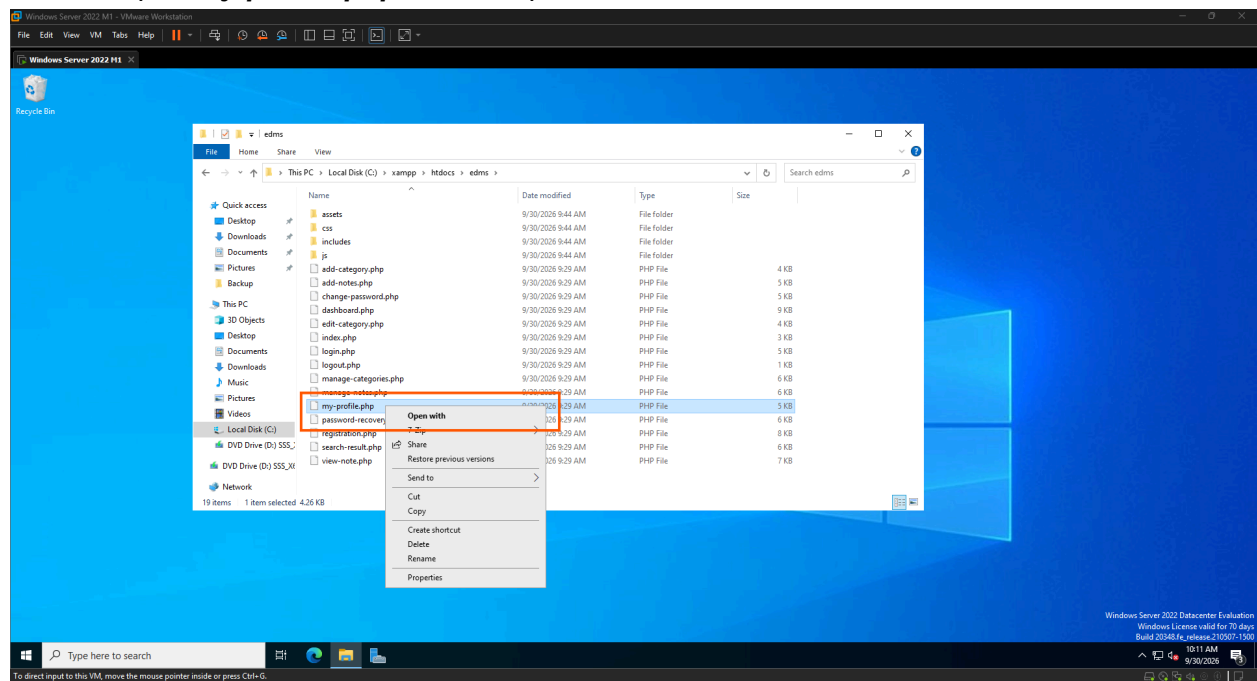
1. Obfuscating source code

Step 1: Obfuscating source code

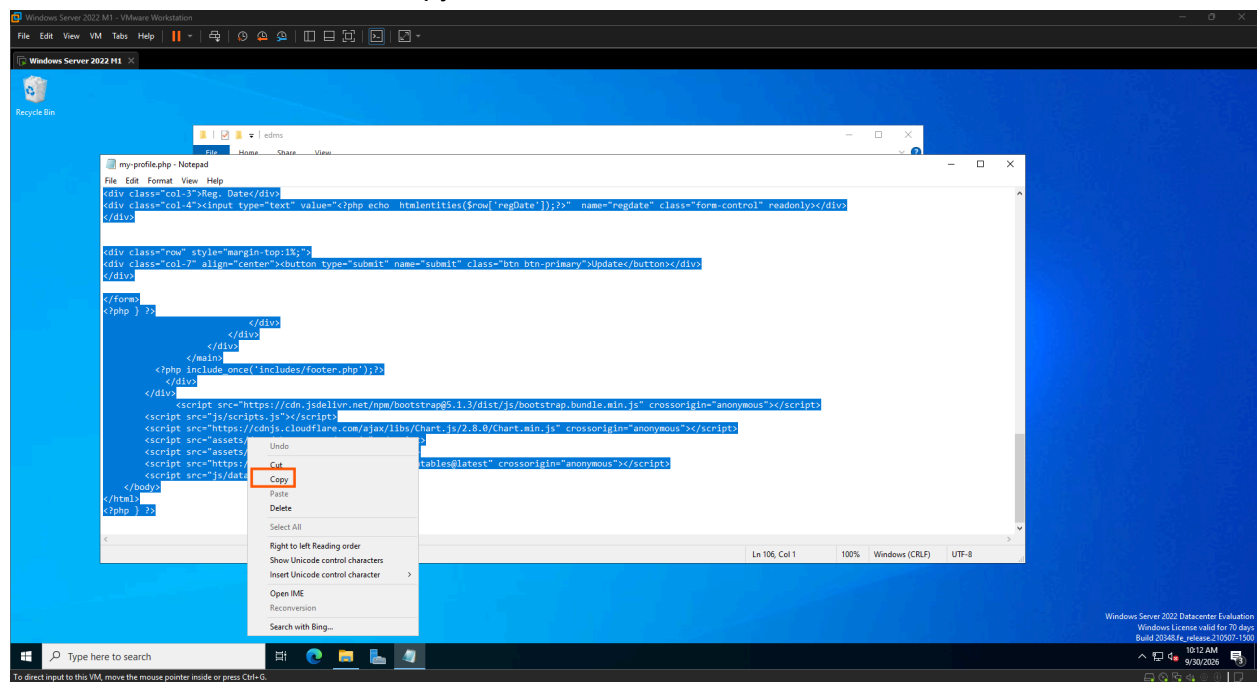
1.1 Launch Windows Server 2022 VM, Navigate to **C:\xampp\htdocs\ledms**



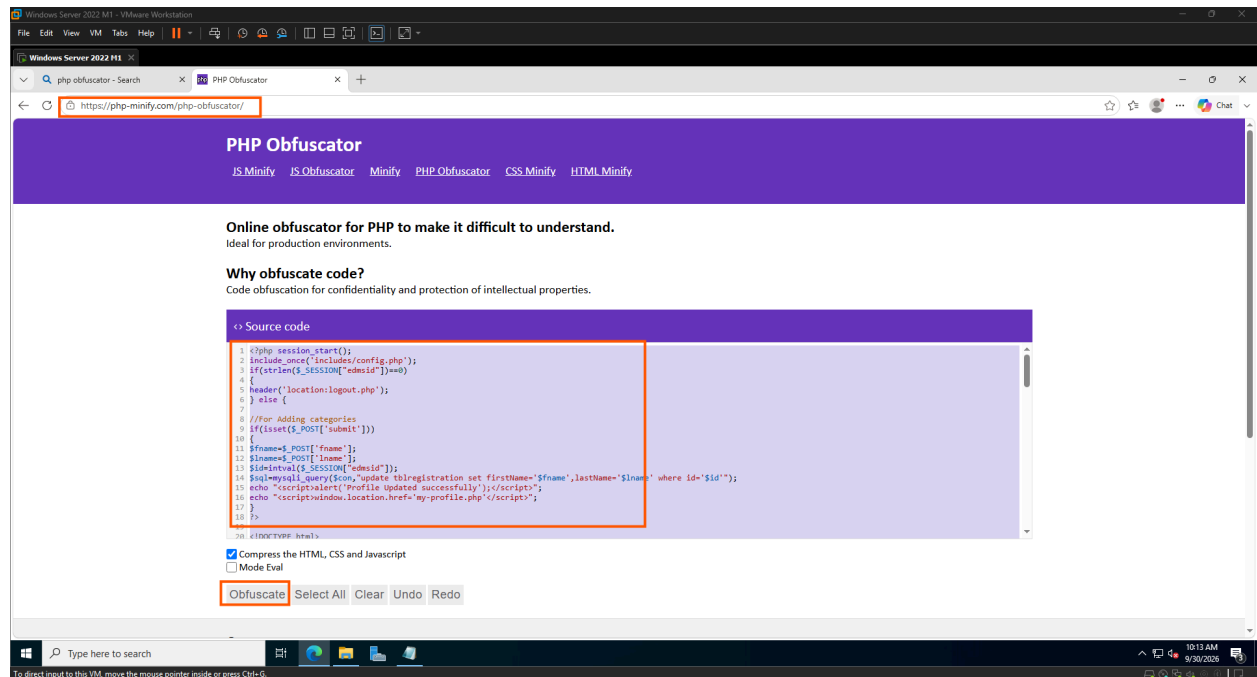
1.2 Now open *my-profile.php* with Notepad



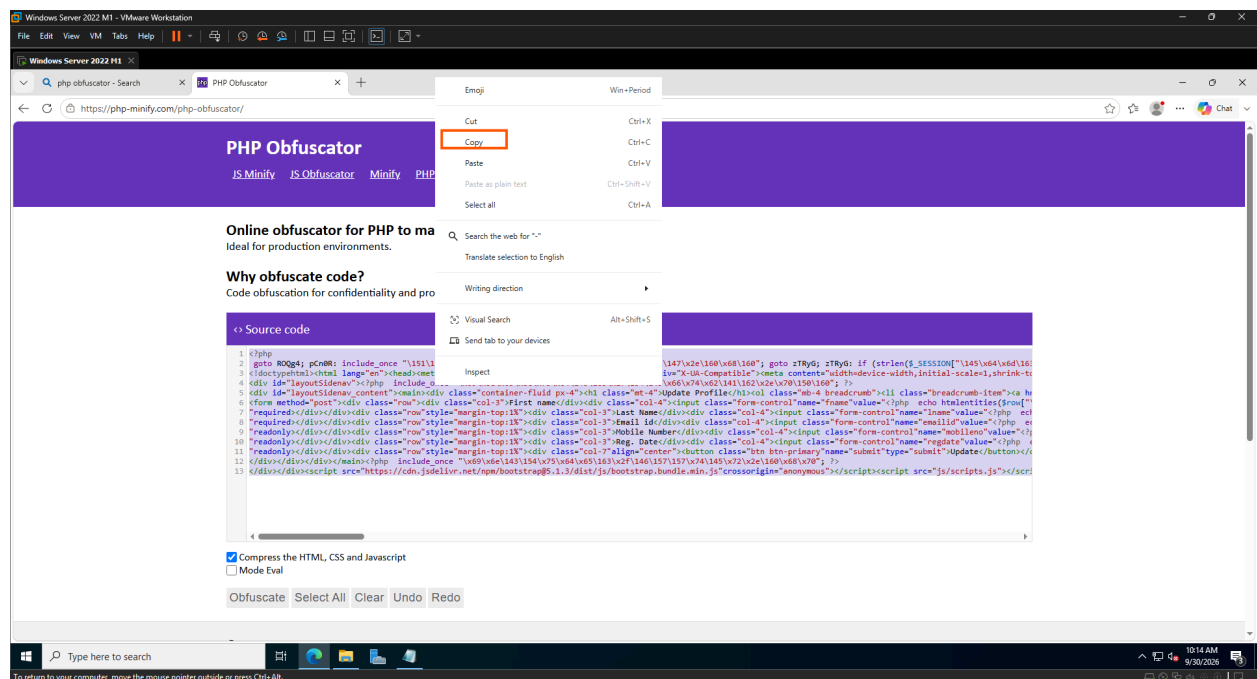
1.3 Select all the content and copy

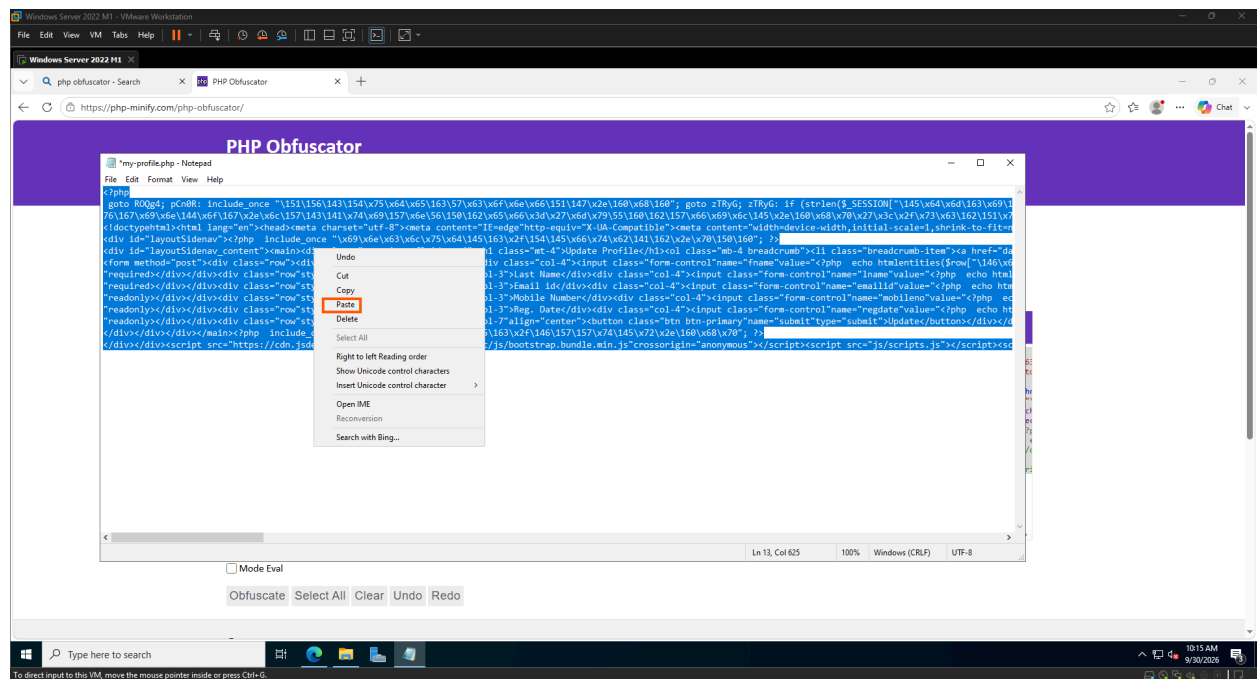


1.4 Open the Edge browser and search for **php obfuscator**, open it and paste the copied content here, then click Obfuscate button

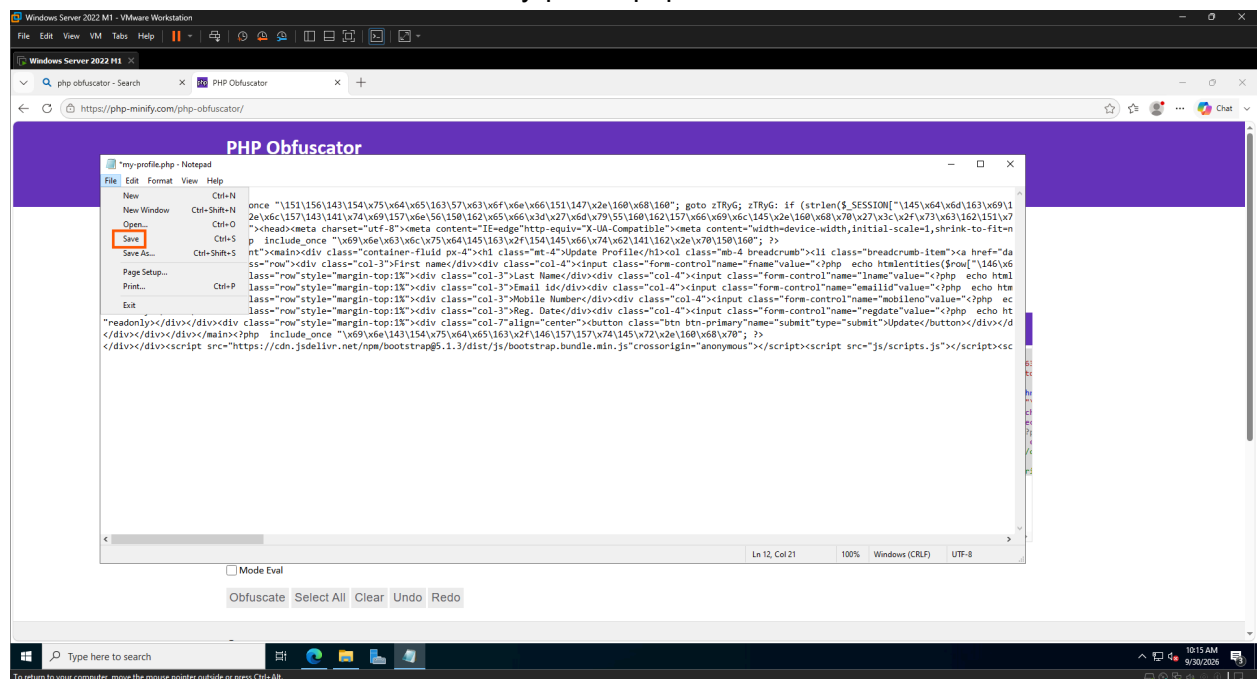


1.5 Now copy the obfuscated code from here & paste into the **my-profile.php** by replacing all the current code there.

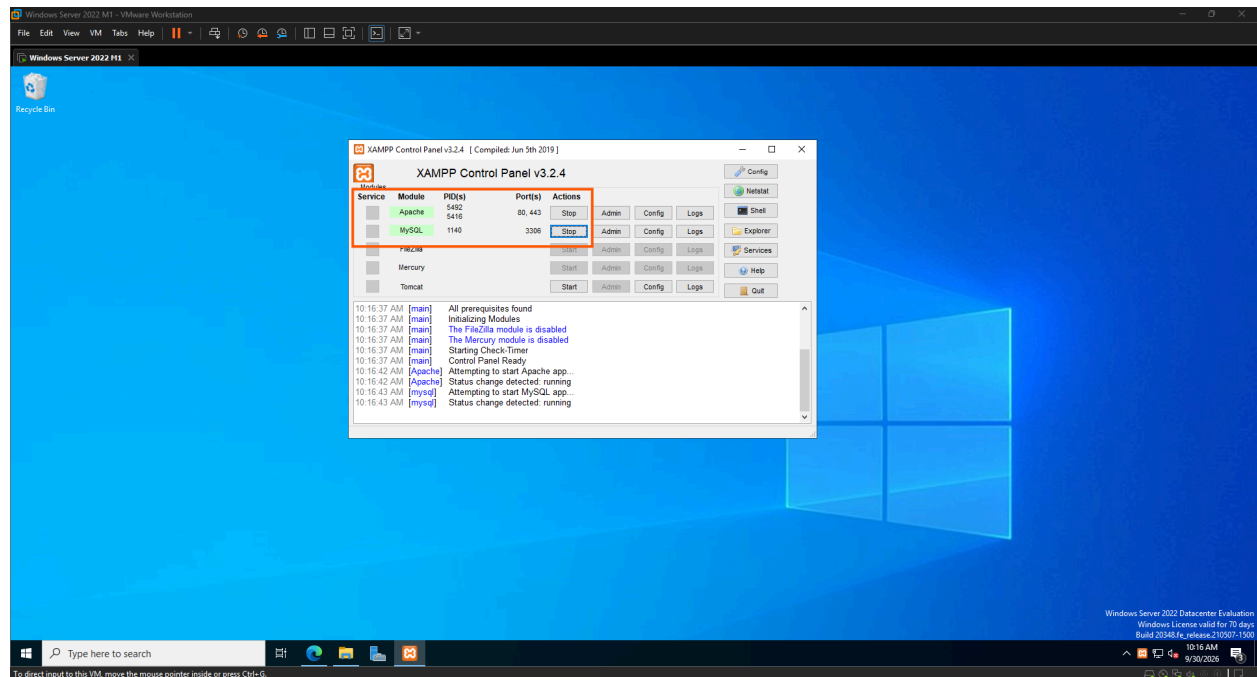




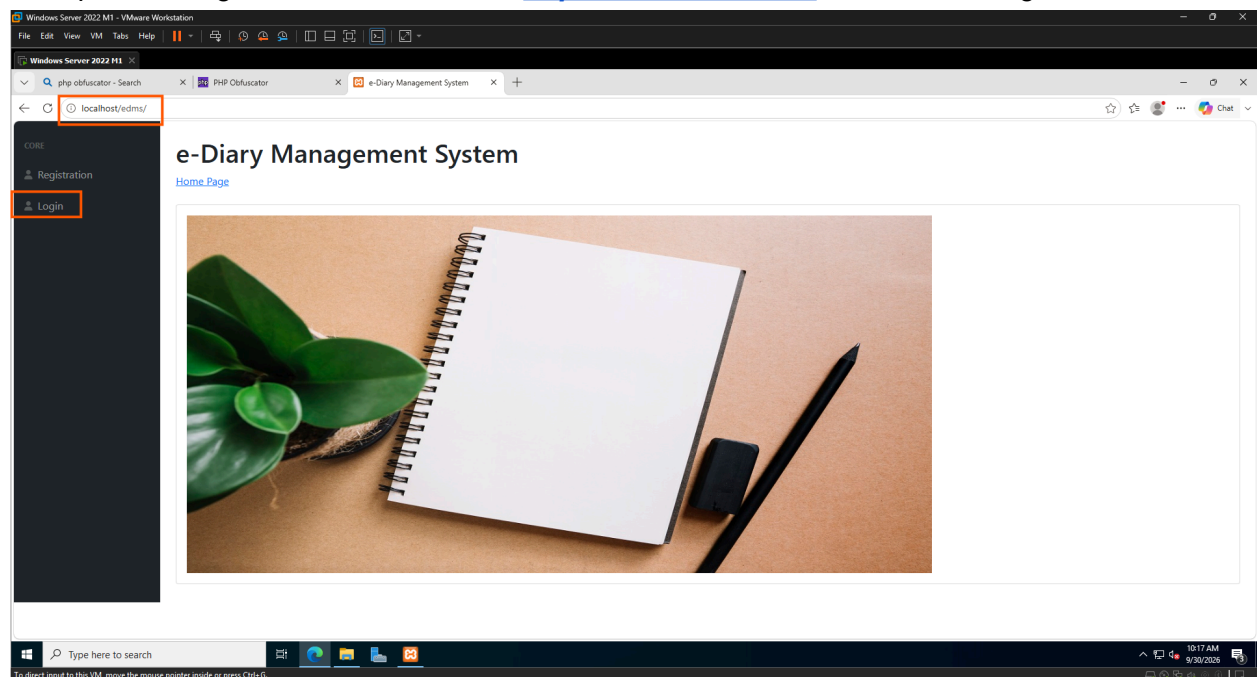
1.6 Save the new obfuscated code of my-profile.php



1.7 Now open **XAMPP** & Start the **Apache** and **MySQL**



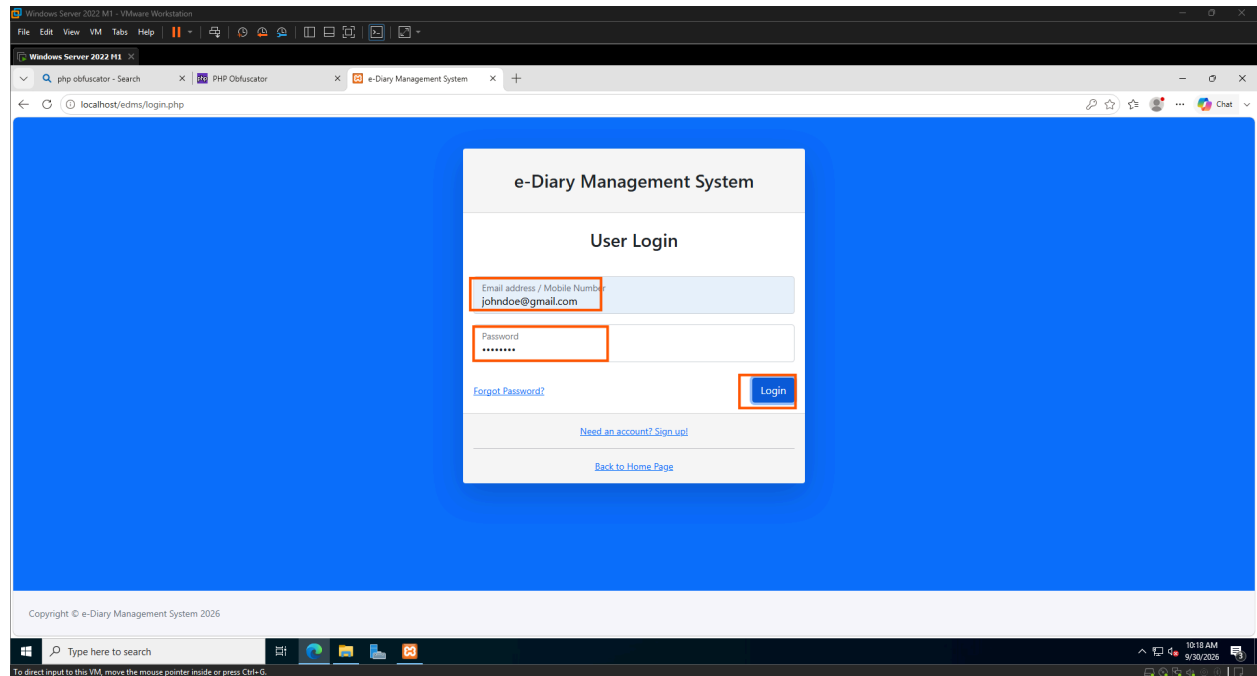
1.8 Open the edge browser and search <http://localhost/edms> then click on login.



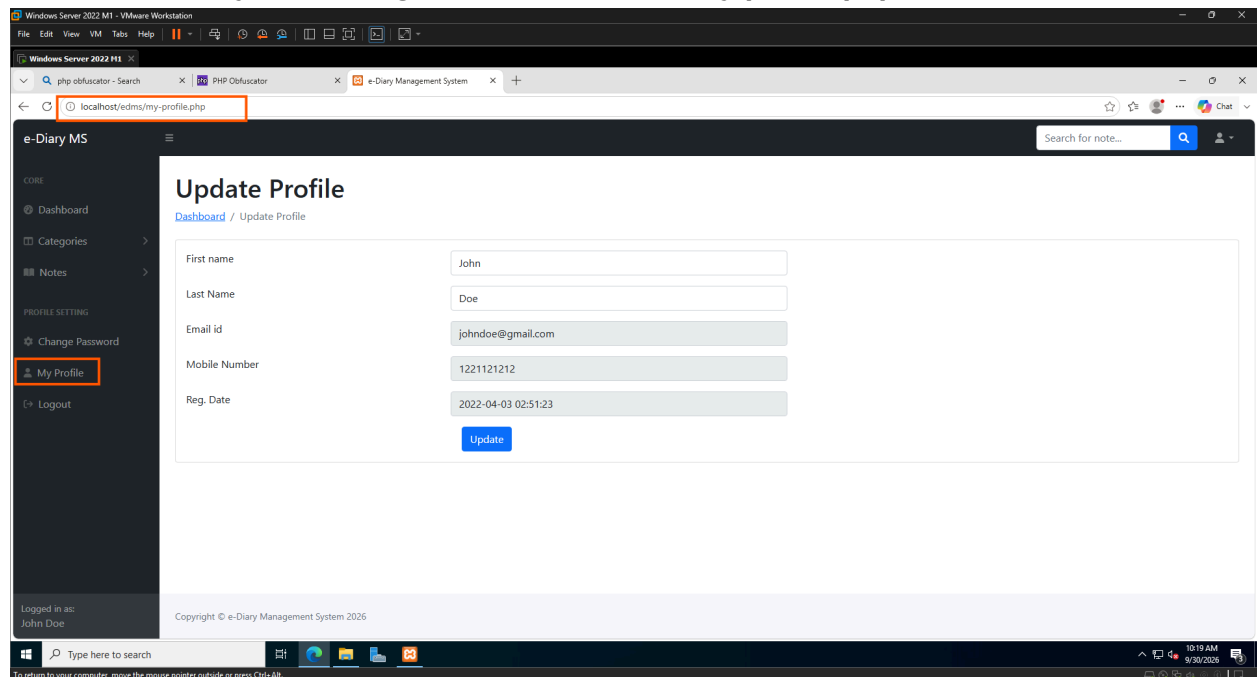
1.9 Use below dummy credentials to Login:

Email: johndoe@gmail.com

Password: Test@123



1.10 Now open **My Profile Page** which is linked with **my-profile.php**



Conclusion:

Obfuscating source code is an effective technique to enhance security by making the code difficult to read and understand, thereby protecting intellectual property and reducing the risk of reverse engineering. While it does not provide complete protection against determined attackers, it adds a significant layer of complexity, acting as a deterrent. However, it is essential to balance obfuscation with performance and maintainability to ensure the application remains efficient and manageable. For maximum security, obfuscation should be used alongside other protective measures such as encryption and secure coding practices.